STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-4300	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **03/05/24**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT HOUSE WATCHES		CROSS-REFERENCE P-3100 ROLL CALL		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish a house watch program for the citizens of Sarpy County and to establish procedures for Road Patrol deputies to monitor the residences assigned to the house watch program.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office provides a program for the citizens of Sarpy County to request specific checks to be performed on their residence when that residence will be unoccupied for a period of time. This allows for additional security and peace of mind for citizens who leave on vacation or who must be away from their homes for an extended period of time (a minimum of 3 days). Occupied or vacant homes shall not qualify for the house watch program.

III. Procedures:

A. House Watches-Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. The shift supervisor or his or her designee shall ensure house watches are distributed to the deputies. Day Shift shall be assigned the top half of the list, and Night Shift shall be assigned the bottom half.

2. The shift supervisor shall respond to any house watch location where a residence is found unsecured or there is reasonable belief a crime has been committed.

3. Any time a residence is entered regarding a house watch or a crime has occurred, the shift supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or the ADC.

B. House Watches-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Deputies assigned a house watch shall physically inspect the residence at least one time during the shift.

a) The deputy shall ensure that all doors and windows are secured.

b) The deputy shall check for any signs of criminal activity.

2. Deputies shall advise Communications when conducting a house watch:

a) The deputy shall advise his or her district assignment, house watch, and then after Communications has responded, the deputy shall advise the number assigned to the house watch. (e.g. District 515, house watch <*Communications Response*> house watch number 45-06).

b) A deputy may also generate (self-initiate) a house watch via his or her patrol units MDC (preferred method).

(1) The deputy shall advise district assignment, house watch MDC, and ensure Communications acknowledges the radio traffic (e.g., District 515 house watch MDC).

c) The deputy shall not advise the address of the house watch over the radio unless an emergency situation exists.

d) Deputies should advise Communications if any vehicles not listed on the house watch are on location.

e) If after the inspection the deputy finds no signs of criminal activity or unauthorized entry, the deputy shall notify Communications that the residence is “secure” (e.g. District 515, residence is secure, in-service).

3. If a deputy finds signs of criminal activity or a residence is found to be unsecured, the deputy shall notify Communications and request a supervisor.

4. Deputies may be requested by Communications to respond to a house watch after the owners have returned to verify their identity.

5. Any citizen requesting a house watch should be directed to contact Sarpy County Communications.